

Report under Texas Business and Commerce Code Section 120.053

Information on YouTube's transparency reporting under Texas Business and Commerce Code §120.053

YouTube is producing transparency reports with details on its acceptable use policies and practices as part of efforts to provide greater transparency to Texan users. This report is in addition to the various reports we already produce that provide data and shed light on how and why users raise complaints, how we respond to those complaints, how we enforce our Community Guidelines and content policies, and how we comply with local laws to keep users safe.

This report outlines information about YouTube during the specified reporting period, July 1, 2025 to December 31, 2025. We expect to submit reports covering subsequent data periods as specified in Texas Business and Commerce Code §120.053.

Acceptable use policies

YouTube's [Terms of Service](#) highlights various policies that outline what is not allowed on YouTube. These policies include YouTube's [Community Guidelines](#), [Advertiser-Friendly Content Guidelines](#), [Copyright](#), and [related policies](#), which are made accessible in YouTube's [Help Center](#) and apply to all types of content on YouTube.

Implementing and enforcing YouTube policies

Each of YouTube's policies is carefully thought through so they are consistent, well-informed, and can be applied to content from around the world. New policies go through multiple rounds of testing before they go live to ensure YouTube's global team of content reviewers can apply them accurately and consistently.

YouTube relies on a combination of humans and machine learning technology to flag inappropriate content and enforce YouTube's Community Guidelines. This collaborative approach helps improve the accuracy of YouTube's models over time, as models continuously learn and adapt. In some cases, that same machine learning automatically takes an action, if there is high confidence that content is violative given information about similar or related content that has been previously removed.

Machine learning identifies potentially violative content at scale and nominates for review content that may be against YouTube Community Guidelines. Content moderators then help confirm whether the content should be removed or remain on the platform. It also means YouTube's enforcement systems can manage the sheer scale of content that is uploaded to YouTube, while still digging into the nuances that determine whether a piece of content is violative.

Community Guidelines enforcement

After a creator's first Community Guidelines violation, they will typically get a warning with no penalty to their channel. They will have the chance to take a policy training to allow the warning to expire after 90 days. Creators will also get the chance to receive a warning in another policy category. If the same policy is violated within that 90-day window, the creator's channel will be given a strike.

If the creator receives three strikes in the same 90-day period, their channel may be permanently removed from YouTube. In some cases, YouTube may terminate a channel for a single case of severe abuse, as [explained](#) in the Help Center. YouTube may also remove content for reasons other than Community Guidelines violations, such as a first-party privacy complaint or a court order. In these cases, creators will not be issued a strike.

If a creator's channel gets a strike, they will receive an email, and can have notifications sent to them through their mobile and desktop notifications. The emails and notifications received by the creator explain the action taken on their content and which of YouTube's policies the content violated. More detailed guidelines of YouTube's processes and policies on strikes are available [here](#).

YouTube also reserves the right to restrict a creator's ability to create content on YouTube at its discretion. A channel may be turned off or restricted from using any YouTube features. If this happens, users are prohibited from using, creating, or acquiring another channel to get around these restrictions. This prohibition applies as long as the restriction remains active on the YouTube channel. A violation of this restriction is considered circumvention under YouTube's [Terms of Service](#), and may result in termination of all existing YouTube channels of the user, any new channels created or acquired, and channels in which the user is repeatedly or prominently featured.

Government removal requests

Governments contact Google, including YouTube, with content removal requests for a number of reasons. Government bodies may claim that content violates a local law, and include court orders that are often not directed at Google, including YouTube, with their requests. More information on government requests to remove content is available on the Google Transparency Report website [here](#).

Copyright enforcement

YouTube offers a suite of copyright management tools that gives rightsholders control of their copyrighted material on YouTube. These tools have allowed creativity to thrive, while giving creators and artists the tools and resources needed to manage their content online. The Copyright Transparency Report shares information about the copyright enforcement efforts on YouTube. More information on copyright enforcement is available on the Google Transparency Report website [here](#).

Coordinated influence campaigns

Google's Threat Intelligence Group (GTIG) and Trust & Safety Team work to monitor malicious actors around the globe, disable their accounts, and remove the content that they post, including but not limited to coordinated information operations.

One of GTIG's missions is to understand and disrupt coordinated information operations threat actors. Their work enables Google teams to make enforcement decisions backed by rigorous analysis. Their investigations do not focus on making judgments about the content on Google platforms, but rather examining technical signals, heuristics, and behavioral patterns to make an assessment that activity is coordinated inauthentic behavior.

GTIG regularly publishes its TAG Bulletin, updated quarterly [here](#), which provides updates around coordinated influence operation campaigns terminated on Google's platforms, as well as additional periodic blog posts. In the Bulletin, GTIG often notes when findings are similar to or supported by those reported by other platforms.

Monetization policies

If a Creator has turned on ads monetization for a video but our reviewers and automated systems identify that the video does not comply with our Advertiser-Friendly Content Guidelines, the video will have limited or no ads appear against it. However, if Creators believe that their video is still suitable for all brands, they can request human review of that video. More on our monetization policies [here](#).

YouTube video demonetizations due to violations of monetization policies

2,475,575

Alerting and actioning under our Community Guidelines policies

See the [Community Guidelines enforcement report](#) for data on alerting and actioning globally under Community Guidelines policies during the reporting period.

Removed, appealed, and reinstated videos

YouTube relies on teams around the world to review flagged videos and remove content that violates our Community Guidelines; restrict videos (e.g., age-restrict content that may not be appropriate for all audiences); or leave the content live when it doesn't violate our guidelines or warrants an exception for educational, documentary, scientific or artistic context. Reviewers evaluate flagged videos against all of our Community Guidelines and policies, regardless of the reason the video was originally flagged.

YouTube's Community Guidelines are enforced consistently across the globe, regardless of where the content is uploaded. When content is removed for violating our guidelines, it is removed globally.

Creators have 90 days to submit an appeal after the video's removal, so videos removed during a previous time period may be appealed in the current reporting period. Note that a reinstatement may be in response to an appeal or video removal that occurred in a previous time period.

Human flags by flagger type

In addition to our automated flagging systems, YouTube provides users the opportunity to report or flag content that they believe violates YouTube's Community Guidelines or other policies. Users can report content using YouTube's flagging feature. Details on how to report different types of content using YouTube's flagging features are outlined in YouTube's Help Center.

YouTube also has a [Priority Flagger](#) program, through which non-governmental organizations and government agencies who are particularly effective at identifying certain types of harmful content have access to additional reporting processes and prioritized review of their flags. These flags are reviewed under the same policies and procedures as all other pieces of content we review.

Channels removed

A YouTube channel is terminated if it accrues three [Community Guidelines strikes](#) in 90 days, has a single case of severe abuse (such as predatory behavior), or is determined to be wholly dedicated to violating our guidelines (as is often the case with spam accounts). When a channel is terminated, all of its videos are removed.

Additional restrictions on content

YouTube uses a combination of people and automated systems to detect and flag potentially age-inappropriate content for minors, which is then age-restricted. Age restrictions may be placed on content otherwise allowed under other Community Guidelines policies. More on age-restricted content [here](#).

Age restrictions applied

5,638,833